been dovetailed into a more determined development of its own North-East states and coordinated with greater access and connectivity in Bangladesh. Relations with South-East Asia have acquired a greater security dimension and higher stronger political profile, underlined by the presence of all ASEAN leaders at the Republic Day celebrations in 2018. On the other side, the relatively narrow relations with Gulf countries, earlier focused mainly on energy and community, have also acquired similar facets of security and politics. It did require greater dexterity, given the divisions among Gulf countries and their issues with Iran.

The same sense of purpose has guided an integrated approach to the maritime domain, spelt out by the SAGAR doctrine in March 2015, that has created a basis for robust cooperation with Indian Ocean island nations and beyond.

In recent years, India has concluded White Shipping agreements with seventeen nations, provided coastal surveillance radars to eight of them, naval capabilities to six, and set up an integrated fusion centre for maritime domain awareness. It has extended soft Lines of Credit in the field of defence to eleven nations, deputed training teams to eleven as well, and offered capacity building to a large number of foreign militaries. Its hydrographic cooperation covers five countries in the Indian Ocean. And its three annual HADR exercises have helped it to mount seven major operations in the last five years, stretching from Fiji to Yemen and Mozambique. The reality is that in maritime policy too, India could succeed in doing more with less. A lighter footprint, applications of technology, embrace of partnerships and a propensity towards frugality have come together. The net impact of all this has been very much more because working with international partners has provided a multiplier effect.

Africa has also started to be treated as the neighbourhood beyond the horizon. The India-Africa Forum Summit in October 2015 saw the unprecedented participation of all fifty-four nations, forty-one of them at the leader level. Visits of the senior Indian leadership to Africa have been stepped up sharply and the development assistance and training put on a firmer track. The decision to open new embassies in eighteen African nations speaks of the priority that this region is now receiving. A greater